INFO 102

HW#1: Information Systems [10pts]

Description of Topic

Organizations rely on information systems for a host of reasons, and they play critical roles in several contexts. Data, information and knowledge reflect how raw facts can be combined, assembled and analyzed to add meaning and value. Characteristics of information that add to its value include timeliness, accuracy, and completeness. The young discipline of information systems attracts faculty and students from many fields. Common applications include the Internet of Things, big data analytics, e-marketplaces, and collaborative group work.

In your *explanation*, select an information context that interests you. Your explanation should also include a thesis statement (e.g., "I see information systems impacting X because..."). In your *engagement*, you should discuss - who are the *people* using this system? What is the *technology* used in the system? What *processes* are in place now? What *data* are important? In your *reflection*, create a mindmap of concepts that help you understand how information systems play a role in this context. Did you uncover anything surprising or unexpected? **Please highlight the sections where you address these questions.**

Short Paper [10pts]

Due: See schedule in syllabus for specific date/time
Length: 1 page (DOUBLE-spaced, font size 10-12)
Requirements: At least one reference cited in-line and listed in a reference/works cited section in either APA or MLA format.

The short paper should be no longer than two pages (not including references). Your paper should have three sections:

1. Explanation: describe the information context that interests you and why you chose it.
   Provide an overview of what your paper is about, including a thesis statement. What background information is necessary to understand your thesis?
2. Engagement
   What evidence do you have to support your thesis? Who are the *people* using this system? What is the *technology* used in the system? What *processes* are in place now? What *data* are important?
3. Reflection: the deliverable is a mindmap explaining your understanding of the information system, people, processes, data
   Consider the impact of your argument. Why is your argument important? Create a mindmap of concepts that help you understand how information systems play a role. Did you uncover anything surprising or unexpected?

Appendix: *If you use ChatGPT for generating any content of the paper, you must add an Appendix to the paper. In the Appendix, include all the prompts you used and the outcomes generated by ChatGPT (could be in screenshots.) For each prompt and outcome, add your assessments and critiques to explain how you arrived at your final points in the paper.*

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BE SURE TO PUT YOUR NAME ON YOUR PAPER!

Tools to create mindmaps:

A mind map is a graphical representation of ideas and concepts. You can use any of these free tools to generate your mindmap

- https://app.diagrams.net/
- Cmap Software - https://cmap.ihmc.us/
- Bubbl.us mind map - https://bubbl.us/
- Mindmanager - https://www.mindmanager.com/
- Powerpoint/Visio
- The Visual Understanding Environment (VUE) - http://vue.tufts.edu/

Grading Rubric

	Poor [0.5pts]	Adequate [1pt]	Good [2pts]
Explanation	The writer provides little or no background information and thesis statement is missing or difficult to comprehend.	The writer provides some relevant background information and thesis statement is either unclear or incomplete.	The writer provides all relevant background information (cited where appropriate) of the topic and his/her central thesis is clearly stated.
Engagement	The writer provides little or no evidence in support of his/her argument.	The writer provides some evidence in support of his/her argument, but evidence is insufficient.	The writer clearly provides adequate evidence (cited where appropriate) in support of his/her argument.
Reflection	The writer provides little or no description of the importance and impact of his/her argument and analysis is vague or not evident.	The writer somewhat describes the importance and impact of his/her argument but analysis is basic or general.	The writer clearly describes the importance and impact of his/her argument and displays evidence of thoughtful analysis of the topic.
Tone (overall)	The tone is not consistently professional or appropriate for an academic paper.	The tone is generally professional and appropriate for an academic paper.	The tone is professional and appropriate for an academic paper.
Mechanics (overall) & Following Instructions	The writing has many errors, and the reader is distracted by them. Paper does not follow instructions (font size, line spacing, at least one reference in appropriate format)	There are occasional errors, but they don't represent a major distraction or obscure meaning. Paper follows some, but not all, instructions (font size, line spacing, reference format)	The writing is free or almost free of errors. Paper follows instructions (font size, line spacing, reference format)